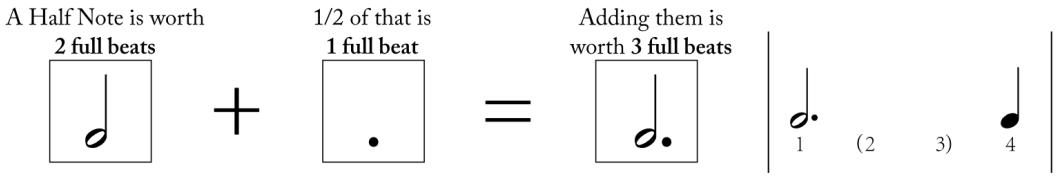
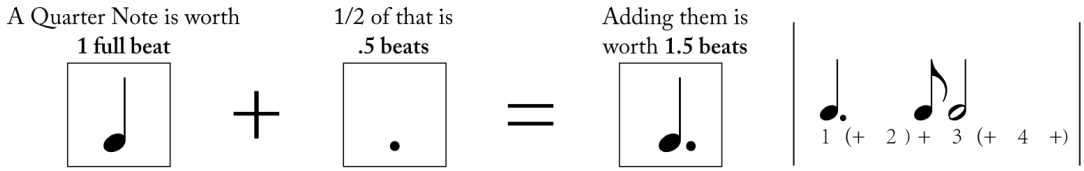
LESSON 11: DOTTED NOTE VALUES

A dot next to a note will extend its length by 1/2 of the orignal note's value. Spoken another way, a dot multiplies the value of a note by 1.5. That still might not be intuitive, so let's take a look at some concrete examples. Placing a dot next to a half note, for instance, creates a note that sustains for three full beats.



Notice though — we could alternatively notate this value of three beats by using ties.

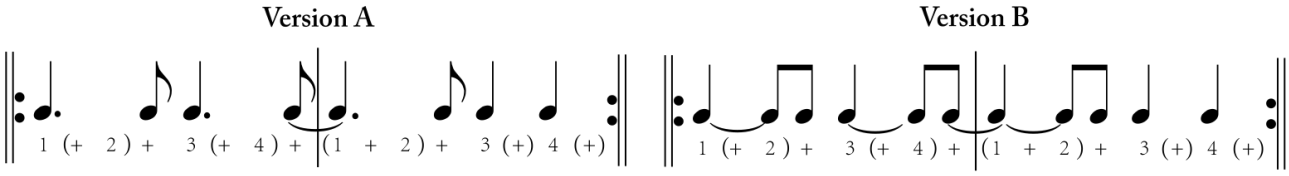
Placing a dot next to a quarter note increases its value from 1 beat to 1.5 beats (or three eighth notes).



Again, this value could be notated using ties instead.

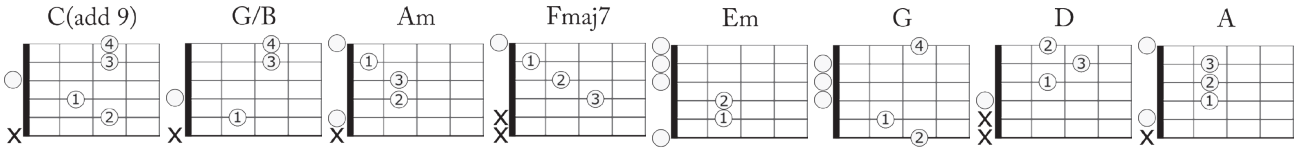
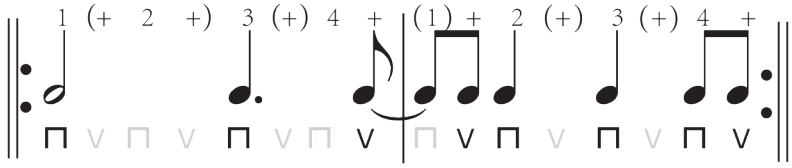
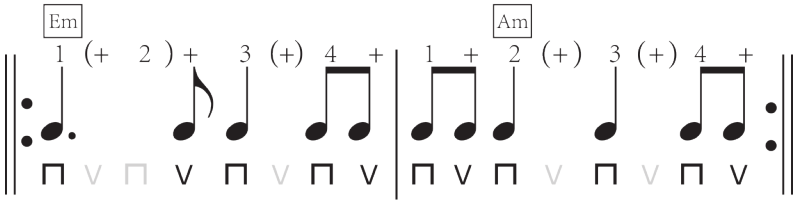
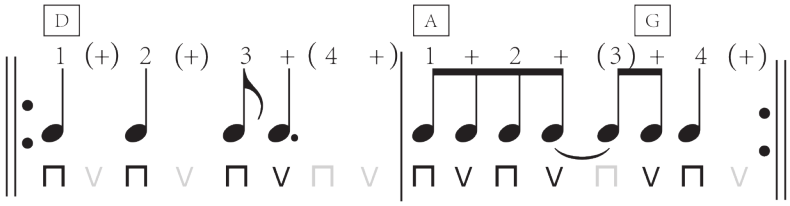
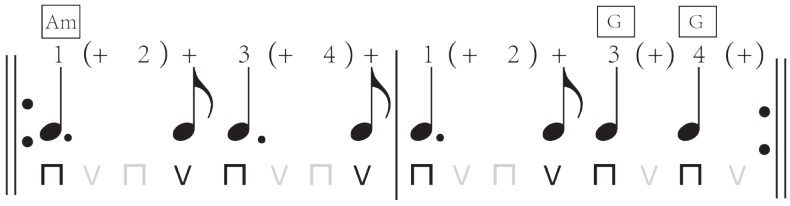
Why Use Musical Ties?

As we've seen, many dotted note rhythms could be written using ties instead. However, using dotted notes is sometimes "cleaner" and easier to read than ties. In this next example, we see the same rhythm written two different ways. For many musicians, Version A is easier to parse than version B.



Exercises (Video #11.1)

Here's four rhythms that can be easily applied to many different chord progressions. The chords used for these examples are all shown here:



Change chords upon each repeat: Cadd9 G/B Am Fmaj7